

CDN Incident Alert: 0070. TLP: CLEAR			Date
Title	PL	Murky Accounts on TikTok Impersonating Polish Presidential Candidates and Political Parties	22/05/2025

Summary

- DRI identified 129 “murky” accounts of unknown origin on TikTok impersonating candidates in the first round of the Polish presidential race and prominent Polish political parties. DRI defines murky accounts as “accounts of unknown origin that appear to impersonate politicians or parties “
- Most accounts had less than 1000 followers, however several enjoyed significant attention and support, with one receiving over 8.1 million likes on its videos
- DRI reported the accounts identified on April 28 to TikTok for removal. Some have since been removed, while others remain up as TikTok argues that they do not violate platform policy against impersonation. Several of these are not clear to us as to as their origin remains unknown.

Incident

On April 28 DRI identified 107 murky accounts. A second collection on May 15 found an additional 22, for a total of 129 accounts, 79 impersonating candidates and 50 impersonating parties. At least one murky account impersonating each candidate was observed. Consistent with previous DRI investigations in the contexts of the Romanian and German elections, far-right parties and politicians had higher rates of murky account support than more mainstream actors – Slawomir Mentzen alone had 20 murky accounts.

Narrative -

Meta narrative: Amplification of various Polish candidates’ and parties’ messaging across TikTok media ecosystem.

Impact

Reach (views, shares, likes etc): Together the 129 accounts amassed over 500,000 followers, and have uploaded almost 7000 videos

Key Objectives and Behaviours

Objective: [Technique T0143.002: Fabricated Persona](#) – These accounts use the logos, profiles, slogans, and overall aesthetic of Polish political parties and candidates in order to deceive users into engaging with their content. This leads to the amplification of party and candidate visibility through approaches that violate TikTok’s policies against impersonation and political campaigning.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action taken: first collection of accounts has been flagged and reported to TikTok, of which 64 were removed by the platform. The remaining 43 are up as the platform argues they do not violate their impersonation policy. Second batch of accounts will be flagged today, 21.05.2025.

Recommendations: TikTok must take more proactive and consistent measures, especially during electoral cycles, to identify and remove murky accounts. Many of these accounts, easily detected and regularly reported by DRI across various context in projects spanning over a year, with Poland being the most recent example, highlight the persistent and widespread nature of this issue. TikTok should further clarify why a portion of flagged accounts for Poland have remained active despite our flagging.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
		Report to be published in June	Duncan Allen, DRI	TikTok	